

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: ACAD-WD-002

Effective: August 1, 2024

Revision: 1.0

Medical Leave of Absence Policy

1. Purpose

A Medical Leave of Absence (MLOA) allows students who are unable to continue their studies due to a serious physical or mental health condition to take a temporary leave without academic penalty, with a guaranteed right to return.

2. Eligibility

Any currently enrolled student who has a documented medical or psychiatric condition that prevents satisfactory academic performance may apply for MLOA. The condition must be supported by documentation from a licensed healthcare provider.

3. Application Process

Students must submit the MLOA Application (Form SA-07) to the Dean of Students Office along with supporting medical documentation. Documentation must include: the provider's name and contact information, the nature of the condition (specific diagnosis not required), the recommended duration of leave, and attestation that the condition is likely to resolve with treatment.

4. Duration and Extension

MLOA is granted for one semester at a time and may be renewed for up to two consecutive semesters. Students requiring leave beyond two semesters must re-apply with updated medical documentation. In exceptional cases, the Dean of Students may grant a third semester of leave.

5. Academic Impact

Courses in progress at the time of MLOA approval will receive a grade of 'W' (Withdrawal). Tuition refunds are processed according to the Tuition Refund Schedule. Financial aid implications should be discussed with the Financial Aid Office prior to departure.

6. Return from MLOA

Students returning from MLOA must submit a Return from Leave Application at least 6 weeks before the start of the intended return semester. Medical clearance from a licensed provider is required, confirming that the student is able to return to full-time academic work. See Return from Leave Procedure (ACAD-WD-005).

